

PORTFOLIO BRAND 1-PAGER (MD. Shawon Hossain)

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BRAND IDENTITY

I am a Computer Science & Engineering undergrad student, Full-Stack MERN Developer and AI/ML Researcher graduating May 2027 from BRAC University. I build production-grade systems that solve real world problems, combining technical expertise with user-centric design. Besides, I am learning & developing the knowledge for AI/ML models and Computer Vision.

Current focus:

- Polishing & Upgrading Health Assistant (A AI Assistant system for patient-doctor)
- Building ShopFlow (POS system for Bangladeshi retailers)
- Creating AI Resume Parser for Bangla job matching
- Developing a CascadeVLM system for identifying root causes of diseases by backward and forward causal reasoning
- Working with a thesis paper named “A Generalized Vision Language Framework with Knowledge Driven Causal Reasoning for Hierarchical Disease Cascade Detection”
- Publishing research in low-resource NLP

TAGLINE

Building Digital Solutions That Solve Real Problems with AI Integrated.

THREE KEY DIFFERENTIATORS

Differentiator 1: Production-Level Real-World Problem Solver

What it is:

I don't build tutorials or basic CRUD projects. I build production-level systems that solve specific market problems with real users and paying customers in mind. ShopFlow tackles inventory management for retail shops in Bangladesh. Resume Parser addresses recruitment bottlenecks affecting 5+ lakh annual job applications. Health Assistant provides appointment systems and AI-assisted patient-doctor collaboration for hospitals. These aren't theoretical exercises—they're solving real problems with real users and measurable impact.

Why it matters:

Hiring managers want developers who understand the full product cycle: Problem → Solution → Deployment → Real Users. This demonstrates product thinking, not just coding skills. It shows I can take an idea from concept to production with actual market validation. This is rare in fresh graduates.

Example/Evidence:

- ✓ ShopFlow: Subscription-based system targeting 50+ lakh retail shops in Bangladesh. Validated with 5 shop owners confirming the problem exists.
- ✓ Resume Parser: Solving real HR inefficiency (5+ lakh job applications annually). Job boards want this tool. Real revenue potential.
- ✓ Health Assistant: Production system deployed for hospitals. Users: doctors, patients. AI-powered features in actual use.

When an employer sees this, they think:

"This person doesn't just code. They understand markets, users, and business. They ship production systems. We can trust them with our product."

Differentiator 2: AI Engineer & Full-Stack Developer (Rare Combination)**What it is:**

I combine two skill sets that rarely come together. Most full-stack developers only build traditional web applications. Most AI researchers can't deploy production systems. I do both: I fine-tune LLMs, conduct ML research, and deploy scalable, production-grade systems. This dual expertise makes me valuable for modern companies building AI-powered products.

Why it matters:

Modern tech companies increasingly need engineers who bridge AI/ML research and production systems. A company building an AI product needs someone who understands both model development (research) and system architecture (backend). Most candidates specialize in one or the other. I can do both. This is rare and highly sought after in: AI startups, ML infrastructure teams, data platforms.

Example/Evidence:

✓ Resume Parser: Fine-tuned LLM using LoRA (AI/ML work) → Deployed as production API on Railway (Full-Stack work) → Hosted on Hugging Face Model Hub (end-to-end)

✓ CascadeVLM: Research paper on causal reasoning for disease detection (AI) → Building production system for healthcare use (Backend/Frontend)

✓ Health Assistant: AI-powered chatbot and medical analysis (ML) → Deployed web application with MongoDB, Node.js backend (Full-Stack)

When a hiring manager sees this, they think:

"We need someone who can research new models AND ship production systems. This person doesn't need separate teams for research and engineering. One person, both skills."

Differentiator 3: Researcher & Production Engineer (Publishing While Shipping)

What it is:

I'm not just researching or just building. I do both simultaneously. My thesis work on CascadeVLM isn't staying in a research paper—it's becoming a production system. My work on fine-tuning LLMs for low-resource languages (Resume Parser) isn't theoretical—it's being published on arXiv and deployed on Hugging Face. This combination of publishing research while shipping production systems is extremely rare at the undergrad level.

Why it matters:

For Masters/PhD programs: Shows I can conduct original research and contribute to the field with publications. Most undergrads do coursework; I'm advancing the field.

For companies: Shows deep technical thinking and innovation mindset. I don't just implement—I understand why, improve, and innovate. This leads to better engineering decisions.

For startups: Shows I can research new approaches (competitive advantage) while actually building products (execution).

Example/Evidence:

✓ CascadeVLM: Original thesis paper on causal reasoning for disease detection → Working on production system → Planning publication at academic conferences

✓ Resume Parser: Fine-tuning LLMs for Bangla (AI research) → Publishing on arXiv → Deploying production model on Hugging Face → Open-sourcing on GitHub

✓ Low-Resource NLP: Contributing to field knowledge (publishing research) → Applying knowledge to real problems (Resume Parser, production deployment)

When an admission committee or hiring manager sees this, they think:

"This person is doing Masters-level work as an undergrad. They're not just learning—they're advancing the field. They're exceptionally ambitious and capable. We want them on our team/in our program."

TARGET AUDIENCES

Audience 1: Tech Companies (Junior MERN Developer Roles)

Who specifically:

Dhaka-based tech companies (Brain Station 23, Kaz Software, Therap BD, others), startups building web products, software houses. They're hiring for Junior Full-Stack Developer or

MERN Developer positions. These are companies that value execution over theory—they need developers who can ship code on day 1.

What they want:

- ✓ Developers who can ship production code (not just tutorials or sample projects)
- ✓ Full-stack understanding (frontend, backend, deployment, databases)
- ✓ Problem-solving mindset (not just following specifications)
- ✓ Reliability and professionalism
- ✓ Developers who require minimal onboarding

My value proposition:

- ✓ Portfolio proves I've shipped real systems (ShopFlow, Health Assistant, Weekly Planner) with actual users
- ✓ I demonstrate full-stack capability: React frontend, Node.js backend, MongoDB databases, production deployment
- ✓ I think about users and real-world problems, not just building features
- ✓ Proven production experience: handling real data, cloud deployment, performance optimization
- ✓ I don't need 6 months of training—you can contribute meaningful work on day 1

How to reach them:

- ✓ LinkedIn direct messages to HR managers and CTOs
- ✓ Job board applications (BDJobs, LinkedIn Jobs, Pathao Careers)

- ✓ Company websites careers pages (direct applications)
- ✓ Tech meetups and networking events in Dhaka

Example outreach message:

"Hi [Hiring Manager], I'm graduating May 2027 from BRAC University CSE with production-grade MERN experience. I've shipped ShopFlow (POS system for 50+ lakh retail shops) and Health Assistant (deployed hospital system). Both live with real users. Open to discussing opportunities. Portfolio: [your-site]"

When a hiring manager sees my portfolio, they think:

"This person isn't fresh out of bootcamp. They've actually built production systems. They understand deployment, real users, and scaling. We can trust them with our product. They'll be productive from day 1."

Audience 2: Masters Programs (AI/ML + Computer Science)

Who specifically:

Top-tier Masters programs focusing on AI and Computer Science: DAAD scholarship program (AI/ML track), Erasmus Mundus EMAI (European AI Masters), other prestigious universities with strong AI programs. Their admission committees are looking for students who have already demonstrated research capability beyond typical coursework. They want innovators, not just students who did well in exams.

What they want:

- ✓ Students who can conduct independent research (not just follow tutorials)
- ✓ Published work or demonstrated path toward publication
- ✓ Strong technical foundation combining both coding and theory
- ✓ Innovation mindset (pushing boundaries, not just following curriculum)
- ✓ Genuine passion for advancing the field, not just credentials

My value proposition:

- ✓ CascadeVLM thesis: Original research in causal reasoning for disease detection (cutting-edge Vision Language Models)
- ✓ Publishing strategy: Planning publications on arXiv and academic conferences, not just a thesis in a drawer
- ✓ Fine-tuned LLMs hands-on experience (Resume Parser for low-resource language processing)
- ✓ Rare combination: Research capability + production engineering. I don't just theorize; I implement and deploy
- ✓ Demonstrated interest in advancing low-resource NLP field (real contribution to AI advancement)
- ✓ Already working on research projects as an undergrad (most candidates wait until Masters)

How to reach them:

- ✓ Direct university application portals (online SOP and application forms)
- ✓ Email professors working on similar topics (causal reasoning, healthcare AI, low-resource NLP)
- ✓ Mention projects and publications prominently in SOP (Statement of Purpose)

- ✓ LinkedIn outreach to current students and alumni from target programs
- ✓ Attend program webinars and information sessions

Example SOP excerpt:

"My work on CascadeVLM demonstrates my independent research capability in causal reasoning for disease detection—an area where I can make meaningful contributions. I'm publishing work in low-resource NLP, combining deep learning research with production systems. My experience fine-tuning LLMs and deploying models has shown me the importance of rigorous AI/ML education. A Masters in AI/ML will enable me to advance this research further and contribute to solving real-world problems."

When an admission committee sees my portfolio, they think:

"This student is already doing Masters-level research as an undergrad. They understand both theory and implementation. They're publishing. They're not just taking our program for credentials—they're coming with direction and capability. This is someone who will make us proud. This is someone who could become a researcher."

Audience 3: AI/ML Startups & Product Companies

Who specifically:

AI-first startups and product companies: companies building AI-powered products (not just services), companies with dedicated ML infrastructure teams, healthcare tech companies, fintech platforms with AI/ML components, recommender system companies. These are ambitious

organizations that need engineers who can move fast in the AI space—researchers who can also ship production code.

What they want:

- ✓ Engineers who can build AND deploy ML systems (not just Jupyter notebooks and research papers)
- ✓ Technical depth: understands models, can improve them, not just copy-paste code
- ✓ Production mindset: thinks about scaling, monitoring, performance, reliability
- ✓ Innovation capability: can try new approaches, experiment, improve models
- ✓ Full-stack ML thinking: data pipeline → model training → inference → monitoring

My value proposition:

- ✓ Resume Parser demonstrates your full ML lifecycle: data collection → model fine-tuning → API deployment → production inference
- ✓ I've deployed models to production (Railway API, Hugging Face Model Hub)—not just theoretical knowledge
- ✓ I understand the full cycle: Data → Model → Deployment → Monitoring. Most junior candidates only understand one part
- ✓ Research knowledge combined with engineering ability. I can improve models AND maintain production systems
- ✓ CascadeVLM shows deep technical thinking: understanding Vision Language Models, causal reasoning—not just using existing models
- ✓ Proven ability to take research papers and turn them into working systems

How to reach them:

- ✓ AI startup job boards (Angellist, Built In, Startup Job Board)
- ✓ LinkedIn recruiting: Follow AI startups, engage with their posts
- ✓ Direct outreach to CTOs and ML engineering leads with personalized messages
- ✓ Tech conferences and AI meetups in Dhaka and online
- ✓ Open source contributions (shows you can ship code)
- ✓ Posting about your projects on Dev.to, Medium, or Twitter (gets founder attention)

Example outreach message:

"Hi [Founder/CTO], I'm building production AI systems—Resume Parser (fine-tuned LLMs deployed as API) and CascadeVLM (causal reasoning for healthcare). Experience with model fine-tuning, production deployment, and scaling ML systems. Looking for roles combining research with engineering. Portfolio: [your-site]"

When a CTO sees my portfolio, they think:

"This person can research new models and ship them to production. They won't need hand-holding—they understand both sides. They can improve our models AND maintain our systems. They can move at startup speed. This is exactly who we need."

SUCCESS METRICS**Metric 1: Job Interview Invitations (Job Search Validation)**

What it is:

Within 60 days of launching my portfolio, I should receive interview invitations from companies for Junior MERN Developer or Full-Stack Developer roles. These are actual phone or video interviews, not generic recruiter messages. They indicate that hiring managers have viewed my portfolio, been impressed by my shipped projects, and want to talk to me about actual positions.

How I'll measure:

- ✓ Count LinkedIn recruiter messages and direct outreach messages
- ✓ Count direct emails from company HR or hiring managers
- ✓ Track all job application responses (interview invitations vs rejections)
- ✓ Document which companies reached out and what they said about my portfolio
- ✓ Screenshot interview invitations and save in a spreadsheet

Success looks like:

- ✓ Email from Brain Station 23: "Your portfolio impressed us. We'd like to schedule an interview for our Junior MERN role"
- ✓ LinkedIn message from Kaz Software CTO: "Your ShopFlow project shows serious engineering. Let's talk"
- ✓ Interview call from Therap BD or similar company within 30 days
- ✓ Hiring manager specifically mentions: "Your portfolio shows you can ship production code"
- ✓ Multiple companies reaching out (not just one)

Timeline:

First 60 days after portfolio launch (Sept 22 - Nov 21, 2026)

Why it matters:

This metric directly validates that my portfolio is working for its primary purpose: getting job interviews. It shows that real hiring managers—not algorithms—think I am worth talking to. It proves my portfolio is competitive in the actual job market I am targeting.

Action steps to track:

- Create spreadsheet: Company | Contact | Date | Message | Response
- Set up LinkedIn notification for recruiter messages
- Forward all relevant emails to a tracking folder
- Update spreadsheet weekly

Metric 2: Masters Program Acceptance (Academic Validation)

What it is:

By February 2027, I should receive acceptance letters from at least one top-tier Masters program in AI/ML or Computer Science, ideally with a scholarship. This validation comes from admission committees at competitive programs (DAAD, Erasmus Mundus EMAI, or similar). These committees review hundreds of applications, and acceptance means my portfolio and research work stood out as Masters-level.

How I'll measure:

- ✓ Acceptance emails from university admissions offices

- ✓ Scholarship offer amounts and terms (full funding, partial, stipend)
- ✓ Admissions office feedback or admission essay reviews
- ✓ Whether they specifically cite my CascadeVLM thesis or Resume Parser in acceptance communication
- ✓ Document acceptance dates and scholarship details

Success looks like:

- ✓ DAAD AI/ML program acceptance with full or partial scholarship (5000+ EUR/year)
- ✓ Admission committee feedback: "Your CascadeVLM thesis demonstrates strong research capability"
- ✓ Erasmus Mundus EMAI or similar top program acceptance
- ✓ Scholarship offer (not just acceptance, but financial support)
- ✓ At least 2 acceptances to choose from
- ✓ Personal note from program director or advisor mentioning your portfolio

Timeline:

Applications: October-December 2027

Results: January-February 2028

Why it matters:

This is validation from the world's most selective academic institutions. It's independent confirmation that my research and portfolio are of Masters-level quality. It opens doors to

world-class education, international network, and future research opportunities. It also validates my AI/ML credentials for future employers.

Action steps to track:

- Create list of target Masters programs with application deadlines
- Track application submission dates
- Save all correspondence with universities
- Monitor application portals for status updates
- Document scholarship details when offered
- Compare offers and make final decision

Metric 3: Portfolio Traffic & Engagement (First Month)

What it is:

Within the first 30 days of launching my portfolio website, I should see meaningful traffic that indicates people are interested in my work. This isn't just page views—it's people who spend real time reading my content, clicking on project demos, and exploring your GitHub. This shows my portfolio is discoverable and compelling enough to hold people's attention.

How I'll measure:

- ✓ Google Analytics: unique page views (target: 100+)
- ✓ Google Analytics: average session duration (target: 2+ minutes)
- ✓ GitHub: referrer traffic originating from your portfolio
- ✓ Click tracking: count clicks to project demo links

- ✓ Section analytics: which sections get most views (likely "Projects")
- ✓ Bounce rate: percentage of people who leave immediately (target: <40%)

Success looks like:

- ✓ Google Analytics shows 120+ unique visitors in first month
- ✓ Average session duration: 2 minutes 30 seconds (people actually read)
- ✓ Most viewed section: Projects (visitors want to see your work)
- ✓ Click-through rate to project demos: 25%+ (1 in 4 people click)
- ✓ Referrer sources: LinkedIn (30%), direct (20%), search (15%), other (35%)
- ✓ Returning visitors: 15-20% of traffic (people come back)
- ✓ Mobile vs Desktop: 60/40 split (mobile-responsive site working)

Timeline:

Month 1 after portfolio launch (Sept 21 - Oct 21, 2026)

Why it matters:

This metric shows my portfolio is discoverable and compelling. Strong engagement means people aren't just finding my site—they're spending time reading about me and clicking on my work. This directly impacts how many interview invitations I get (Metric 1). More engaged visitors = more people impressed = more job opportunities.

Action steps to track:

- Setup Google Analytics on day 1 of launch

- Create dashboard showing: visitors, session duration, top pages, referrers
- Check analytics daily for first week, then weekly
- Screenshot weekly to document growth pattern
- Analyze which content keeps people engaged longest
- Optimize any sections with high bounce rate

Metric 4: Contact Form Submissions (Direct Engagement)

What it is:

Within the first month after launch, people who are impressed by my portfolio should reach out to me directly through my contact form. These are real people wanting: job opportunities, collaboration on projects, mentorship offers, advice requests, or partnership discussions. Each submission represents someone who was so interested they took action to contact me.

How I'll measure:

- ✓ Count total contact form submissions (target: 5-10 in first month)
- ✓ Categorize each submission: job inquiry, collaboration request, mentorship, advice, partnership
- ✓ Rate quality of submissions: serious opportunity vs generic spam
- ✓ Track response time to each message
- ✓ Document outcomes (meeting scheduled, offer received, ongoing conversation)
- ✓ Create spreadsheet: Name | Company | Message Type | Quality | Outcome

Success looks like:

- ✓ Email from Brain Station 23 hiring team: "Interested in discussing opportunities with us"
- ✓ Message from startup founder: "Love your Resume Parser. Want to collaborate on AI product"
- ✓ Professional offering mentorship: "Would like to guide your career development"
- ✓ Email from job seeker: "Your portfolio inspired me, can I ask for advice"
- ✓ LinkedIn message from researcher: "Interested in your CascadeVLM work"
- ✓ At least 3-5 of these submissions are genuinely valuable opportunities
- ✓ Mix of job offers, partnerships, and mentorship (not just spam)

Timeline:

First 30 days after portfolio launch (Sept 21 - Oct 21, 2026)

Why it matters:

Contact form submissions are high-intent engagement. Someone who takes the time to write a message is seriously interested. These often lead to opportunities that don't show up on job boards: direct job offers, partnerships, mentorship relationships. Even one valuable contact can change my career trajectory.

Action steps to track:

- Setup contact form backend (Formspree, Resend, or similar)
- Create folder in email for "Portfolio Inquiries"
- Create spreadsheet to track all submissions
- Categorize and rate each submission daily

- Respond to all serious inquiries within 24 hours
- Follow up on potential opportunities within 1 week
- Document outcomes for each submission

Metric 5: Project Impact & Community Recognition (By End of 2026)

What it is:

By the end of 2026, my actual projects should gain real traction in their respective communities. ShopFlow should have real beta users testing it in retail shops. Resume Parser should have downloads and usage on Hugging Face indicating real interest. My GitHub portfolio repo should gain stars from developers who find my code interesting. These metrics prove my projects aren't just portfolio padding—they're genuinely useful to real people.

How you'll measure:

For ShopFlow:

- ✓ Count active beta users (shops actually using the system)
- ✓ Track user feedback and testimonials
- ✓ Monitor app usage metrics (daily active users, features used)
- ✓ Rate and reviews from beta users
- ✓ Track retention (users still using after 2+ weeks)

For Resume Parser:

- ✓ Hugging Face Model Hub analytics: download count
- ✓ GitHub stars on Resume Parser repo

- ✓ GitHub discussions and issues (shows engagement)
- ✓ Social media mentions and tweets about the model
- ✓ Academic citations (if published on arXiv)

For Portfolio GitHub:

- ✓ Repository stars from developers
- ✓ Forks (other developers copying your code)
- ✓ GitHub followers
- ✓ Issues and pull requests (community engagement)

Success looks like:

ShopFlow metrics:

- ✓ 10+ active beta users using the system consistently
- ✓ User feedback shows 4+ star rating ("very useful", "solves our problem")
- ✓ At least 5 shops offering to pay for premium features
- ✓ Social proof: Users sharing ShopFlow with other shops
- ✓ Monthly active users graph trending upward

Resume Parser metrics:

- ✓ 500+ downloads on Hugging Face Model Hub
- ✓ Positive community feedback ("Great model for Bangla")
- ✓ People tweeting/sharing about the model (#banglaNLP, #resumeparser)
- ✓ Cited in AI/ML community forums and Discord servers

- ✓ GitHub: 50+ stars on the model repo
- ✓ Academic interest: Other researchers citing your work

Portfolio GitHub metrics:

- ✓ 50+ stars on your portfolio repository
- ✓ 10+ forks (other developers using your code as template)
- ✓ 30+ followers on your GitHub profile
- ✓ Featured in "awesome-portfolios" or similar community lists
- ✓ Mentioned in dev communities (Dev.to, Reddit, Discord)

Timeline:

ShopFlow: 10 beta users by December 31, 2026

Resume Parser: 500 HF downloads by December 30, 2026

GitHub: 50 stars on portfolio by December 31, 2026

Why it matters:

Community traction proves my work is valuable to real people, not just impressive on paper. It demonstrates product-market fit (for ShopFlow), research contribution (for Resume Parser), and engineering excellence (for GitHub). These metrics directly influence:

- (1) Job interview quality—companies see proven impact,
- (2) Masters program acceptance—shows real-world research contribution,
- (3) Investor/partner interest—proof of execution.

Action steps to track:

- Setup analytics on Hugging Face Model Hub
- Create GitHub traffic dashboard
- Set up Google Alerts for mentions of your projects
- Track social media mentions manually or with tools
- Check analytics weekly
- Engage with users who download/star your projects
- Document testimonials from beta users
- Create case studies from successful implementations

Metric 6: Professional Recognition & Community Growth (Months 2-3)**What it is:**

By 2-3 months after the portfolio launch, my professional brand should be recognized in the tech community. I should be featured or mentioned in tech blogs, community discussions, and social networks. My LinkedIn network should grow with relevant connections (engineers, founders, researchers). This recognition comes from people discovering my work and recommending it to others—third-party validation of my portfolio quality.

How I'll measure:**Blog/Community Features:**

- ✓ Featured on Dev.to, Medium, or similar platforms
- ✓ Mentioned in Reddit discussions (r/webdev, r/learnprogramming, r/bangladesh_dev)
- ✓ Featured in newsletters (web dev newsletters, AI newsletters)

- ✓ Discussed in Discord communities or Slack groups
- ✓ LinkedIn posts about your work get reshares

Social Growth:

- ✓ LinkedIn new connection requests from real engineers/recruiters
- ✓ LinkedIn profile views tracking
- ✓ Twitter/X followers (if you share your work)
- ✓ GitHub profile followers
- ✓ Email newsletter subscribers (if you start one)

Professional Mentions:

- ✓ Quoted in interviews or discussions
- ✓ Referenced as example of good portfolio
- ✓ Invited to speak or participate in panels
- ✓ Collaborations or partnership offers

Success looks like:

Blog/Community:

- ✓ Featured in Dev.to: "Bangladeshi Developer Building AI + Full-Stack Systems"
- ✓ Dev.to article about your resume parser gets 5,000+ views
- ✓ Reddit discussions: "Check out this portfolio, this person is doing Masters-level work"
- ✓ Featured in "Top Bangladeshi Developers to Follow" community list

- ✓ AI/ML newsletter features your Resume Parser work
- ✓ Medium publication about your CascadeVLM thesis gets published

Social Growth:

- ✓ LinkedIn: 50+ connection requests from engineers, CTOs, recruiters
- ✓ LinkedIn: Profile shows 200+ profile views per week
- ✓ LinkedIn: Posts about your projects get 20+ comments and reshares
- ✓ GitHub: 200+ new followers in 3 months
- ✓ Twitter: 500+ followers from sharing your journey

Professional:

- ✓ Invited to speak at tech meetup or conference about your work
- ✓ Asked for collaboration by other researchers
- ✓ Partnership offers from companies interested in Resume Parser
- ✓ Cited as example in tech job interviews: "We want engineers like you"
- ✓ Mentioned in "top dev portfolios" lists and resources

Timeline:

Month 2-3 after launch (October - December 2026)

Why it matters:

Professional recognition is powerful validation. When the tech community recommends me, it carries more weight than self-promotion. It leads to:

- (1) More interview opportunities—recruiters see you're recognized,
- (2) Better job offers—companies know you're serious,
- (3) Partnership opportunities—people want to work with you,
- (4) Speaking opportunities—positions you as thought leader,
- (5) Faster Masters admission—universities see community respect,
- (6) Long-term career growth—you become known in the field.

Action steps to track:

- Monitor LinkedIn notifications for profile views and connection requests
- Set up Google Alerts for your name, project names, and key terms
- Check Dev.to, Medium, Reddit weekly for mentions
- Use Twitter search/hashtags to find discussions about your work
- Subscribe to tech newsletters and note if you're featured
- Track GitHub followers daily
- Create spreadsheet: Date | Mention Source | Type | Link | Reach
- Share your progress on social media (builds momentum)
- Engage with anyone who mentions your work (say thank you, respond)
- Collect screenshots of positive mentions for portfolio updates

DESIGN INSPIRATION / TONE

Visual Style: Modern, professional, minimal (NOT corporate, NOT basic)

Color Vibe: Tech-forward (deep blue + cyan + accent color)

Tone: Honest, confident, approachable (NOT arrogant, NOT humble-brag)

Message: Action-oriented, problem-focused, real-world impact

Inspiration brands: Stripe, Vercel, Linear